

Welcome to Vista La Mesa Christian Church!

We are so glad you joined us for worship this morning! We hope you will experience God's deep and unconditional love for you while you are here today.

Vista La Mesa Christian Church (or VLM, as we call it) is a congregation of the Christian Church (Disciples of Christ) in the US and Canada. We humbly acknowledge that we live and serve on the ancestral and unceded territory of the Kumeyaay people. We celebrate the unity and diversity of the Body of Christ, working to make visible the oneness of the Church across all divisions, locally and globally. We celebrate the Lord's Supper (communion) every Sunday and invite everyone to participate, whether you're a member here or not. We will also receive an offering during the service, but we consider your presence with us today your gift!

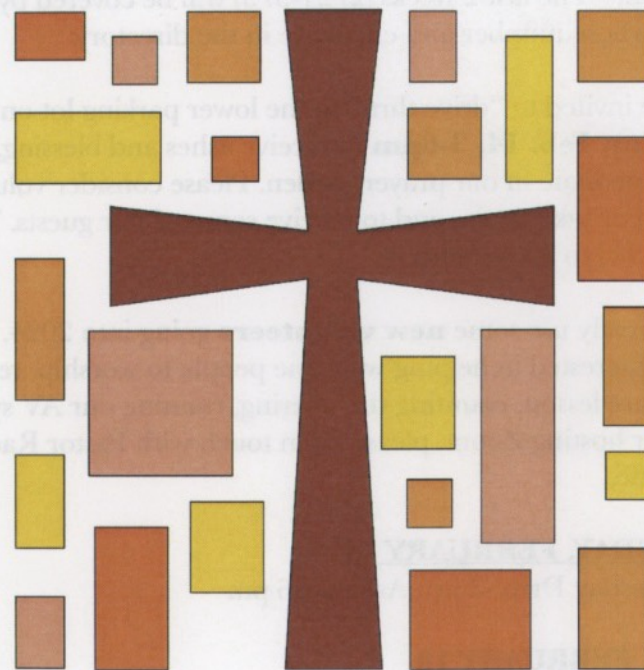
You can follow along in this program ("the bulletin") to see what is happening in each moment of the service. There is no part of worship that you are not invited to participate in. If you need more information, ask someone nearby, and they'll be happy to help you.

You are welcome to keep your children in worship with you! If you would like to have them participate in our children's ministries, they are welcome to do that too. Our staffed nursery is open for infants and younger kids. Older children are invited out for an age-appropriate faith experience after their moment of acknowledgement, as needed. There are also "quiet worship" bags in the entryway, for children who might be restless. But know that we believe that the sound of children in worship is a joyful noise!

After worship, **we'd love to have you join us at coffee hour** in Bailey Hall, with coffee and treats. The restrooms and a drinking fountain are off the hallway at the back of Bailey Hall.

We are glad you are here!

Vista La Mesa Christian Church (Disciples of Christ)



**February 11, 2024
Transfiguration Sunday**

ANNOUNCEMENTS & CALENDAR

Masks are available at both entrances for those who would like to wear one in the building.

Our pastor, Rebecca Littlejohn, is on a six-week renewal leave. She will return on Wednesday, March 6.

Rev. Rachel Cooley Shawler is covering for the first 4 weeks of Pastor Rebecca's half-sabbatical, from Jan. 24 through Feb. 21. She will be your first point-of-contact if you have a pastoral concern or question about church stuff. The last 2 weeks (2/21-3/5) will be covered by Rev. Steve Bridwell, whose number and email are in the directory.

Guests are invited to "drive thru" to the lower parking lot on **Ash Wednesday, Feb. 14, 3-6pm** to receive ashes and blessing, and the option to meditate in our prayer garden. Please consider volunteering with set up or take down, and to receive some of our guests. Talk with Pastor Rachel to learn more.

We could really use some **new volunteers** going into 2024. If you might be interested in helping welcome people to worship, reading the first scripture lesson, counting the offering, running our AV system in worship, or hosting Zoom, please be in touch with Pastor Rachel or Karen Cliffe.

WEDNESDAY, FEBRUARY 14

Ash Wednesday Drive-Thru Ashes, 3-6 pm

SUNDAY, FEBRUARY 18

Disciples Class, 9 am (Bailey Hall & Zoom)

Food Drive

*Happy Birthday to you, Anniversaries too.
May God richly bless you another year through!*

ORDER OF WORSHIP

**At these points, you are invited to rise in body or spirit, as feels worshipful to you.*

Prelude

Ash Wed
Week of Comp
boxes
intention

Deborah Wilson

Welcome

Pastor Rachel

Announcements

***Passing of the Peace of Christ**

One: The peace of Christ be with you. **All: And also with you.**

"Welcome one another, therefore, as Christ has welcomed you." ~Romans 15:7

***Gathering Song**

"Bring Many Names"

#10

***Responsive Call to Worship**

Julie Germain

One: Friends, let us enter in the mystery of transfiguration.

All: We gather to immerse ourselves in the transformative power of divine light.

One: May God's Spirit fall afresh on us, melt us, mold us in our worship & awe this day.

All: That we might be open & transformed to worship God in all we do.

One: Let us surrender to ^{metamorphosis in the} ~~the transformative~~ love of God,

All: And believe in the kingdom of heaven on earth, both here & not yet. Alleluia! Amen.

***Opening Prayer**

Julie Germain

Special Music

"Transform Us"

(Marianna Kirwan)

Moment to Acknowledge our Youngest Disciples & Zoomers

One: Good morning, [name]! Child/Zoomers: Good morning!

ALL: God loves you, [name]!

Children are now invited to a special worship learning experience in the Education Wing

Time of Prayer

Prayers of the People

The Congregation

You are invited to send your prayer requests to Pastor Rachel throughout the week.

Response ~ (One) God, in your mercy, (All) **hear our prayer.** OR

(One) God, with joyful hearts, (All) **we give you thanks!**

Pastoral Prayer

Pastor Rachel

First Reading

Cheryl Davis-Plotts

Psalm 50: 1-6 (OT p. 519)

Second Reading

Mark 9: 2-9 (NT p. 44)

The Good News

Pastor Rachel

"Hearts Broken Open, Melted, Transformed"

Invitation to Discipleship

Pastor Rachel

If you desire to unite with this congregation by confession of faith or transfer of membership, please come forward during the last verse of the Hymn of Response.

*Hymn of Response

#595

"Be Thou My Vision"

Invitation to the Offering

Pastor Rachel

If you are visiting with us, we consider your presence a gift.

Bringing Our Gifts ~ Offertory

Deborah Wilson

*Sung Response

#661 (4x)

hymnal

*Prayer of Dedication

Marianna Kirwan

Invitation to Communion and the Words of Institution

Pastor Rachel

Prayer for the Bread and the Cup with The Lord's Prayer

Steve Bridwell

Our Father who art in heaven, hallowed be thy name.
Thy kingdom come, thy will be done, on earth as it is in heaven. Give us this day our daily bread, and forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors. And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil. For thine is the kingdom and the power and the glory forever. Amen.

Communion Hymn

hymnal

#392

"Draw Us in the Spirit's Tether"

Sharing of the Bread and the Cup

This is Christ's Table. All are welcome to partake.

You are invited to share in this holy meal, by receiving one of the sealed communion cups offered from the tray by the deacon. Please allow the deacons to serve each person directly. Gluten-free wafers are available in the cups in the center section of the tray for those with gluten sensitivities. Please take your empty cups and their seals with you when you leave. There are waste baskets near the exit doors.

*Hymn of Going Forth

#464 (vs. 1, ²3, 5)

"God of Grace and God of Glory"

*Benediction

Pastor Rachel

May God go before you to lead you, behind you to protect you, beneath you to support you, beside you to befriend you. Do not be afraid. May the blessing of God, the Son, and the Holy Spirit be upon you. Do not be afraid. Let us go forth to serve.

*Postlude

Deborah Wilson

All are welcome to trash CUP deacons.

Church Office: (619) 463-9909
Office Email: admin@vlmcc.com

Church Website: www.vlmcc.org
Pastor's Email: pastor@vlmcc.com

CHURCH STAFF

Senior Pastor: Rev. Rebecca Littlejohn
Secretary: Krista Trimlett
Nursery: Stephanie Cadiero
Music Director: Deborah Wilson
Custodian: Scott Tiemann

<u>Thank You</u>	<u>Serving Feb 11</u>	<u>Serving Feb 18</u>
Communion Set Up/Clean Up	Tracy Stockdall	Daphne Flores
Worship Leader	Julie Germain	Mary Jane Fay
Lay Reader	Cheryl Davis-Plotts	Jennifer Lehton
Offering Invitation	Rachel Cooley Shawler	Michael Lewis
Elders	Marianna Kirwan Steve Bridwell	Tim Cliffe Cheryl Davis-Plotts
Deacons	Jennifer Lehton John Lehton	Jenny Angione Claudette Toland Lyn Van Winkle
Children's Ministries	Stephanie Cadiero & Volunteer	Stephanie Cadiero & Volunteer
Greeters	Daphne Flores Ray Adsit	Mary Jane Fay John Lehton
Offering Counters	Jenny Angione Steve Bridwell	Tracy Stockdall John Lehton
AV Tech	Jenny Angione	Jenny Angione
Zoom Tech	Michaela Stockdall	Julie Germain
Coffee Hour Hosts	Jenny Angione Claudette Toland Lyn Van Winkle	Jenny Angione Claudette Toland Lyn Van Winkle